



A memory game, the way Schrödinger would have made it.

A cat in a box is both alive and dead, until somebody looks. In this game, every card is in one of two states, and **looking at it can change it**.

The board

The board has 24 cards and one box in the middle. The box never opens. Don't even try.

Every card has **two states: State A and State B**. Each picture looks different in each state: three burning candles or three blown-out ones, an arrow pointing up or down, a man or his skeleton. All pictures and both of their states are listed at the end of this manual.

How to play

1. **Memorize.** At the start, all cards are shown face up for 10 seconds. **Every card starts in State A.**
2. **The clock starts.** The cards turn face down, and you have 220 seconds.
3. **Open two cards** by clicking them.
4. **A pair** is two cards with the **same picture in the same state**. A pair stays open for the rest of the game.
5. **Anything else is a miss.** You see both cards for a moment, then they turn face down, and **both cards change their state**: State A becomes State B, and State B becomes State A.
6. The game ends when every pair is open, or when the clock reaches zero.

Watch out: the same picture is not always a pair

A pumpkin in State A and a pumpkin in State B are **not** a pair.



+



= **a miss**. Both cards flip. You still have one State A and one State B, only the other way around.

To fix such a **broken pair**, flip **only one of its cards**: open it together with some other card. That costs you a miss, so choose the other card wisely. A good choice is a card from another broken pair. One miss can then fix both pairs.

Every board can always be solved. You can never get stuck with an unfixable card.

Scoring

Your score is **the time left on the clock** when you open the last pair. Every pair and every miss changes the clock:

Event	Clock
Pair in State A	+5 seconds
Pair in State B	±0
Miss	-5 seconds

When the clock reaches zero, the game is over. Your best score is shown in the main menu.

Controls

In the game	
Open a card	Left mouse button
Back to the menu	Esc
In the menu	
Choose	Mouse, or the arrow keys
Select	Left mouse button, or Enter
Quit	Exit button, or Esc

The **Sound** button turns the sound effects on and off. The **Music** button does the same for the music.

The cards

Each game uses 12 of these 16 pictures. Every card starts in State A.

#	Picture	State A	State B
1	Candelabra	 Three candles burning	 Three candles blown out
2	Candle	 Burning, upright	 Burning, upside down
3	Cat	 Black cat	 Ghost cat
4	Flag	 White flag	 Black flag
5	Robot	 Blue	 Red
6	Heart	 Red	 Black
7	Arrow	 Pointing left	 Pointing right
8	Man	 Man in a hat	 Skeleton in a hat
9	Sign	 OPEN	 CLOSED
10	Pumpkin	 Friendly smile	 Wicked grin
11	Traffic light	 Red	 Green
12	Arrow	 Pointing up	 Pointing down
13	Window	 Open	 Curtains drawn
14	Woman	 Woman	 Skeleton
15	Devil	 Grinning	 Angry
16	Thumb	 Pointing right	 Pointing left

*The cat on the back of the cards has been watching all along.
Some say it is the only one who always knows what is inside.*

About this game

Schrödinger's Memory Game was made for **Crashtober 2026**, a Halloween game jam on itch.io celebrating BASIC. The theme: *Schrödinger's Cat - Is it alive? Is it dead? Can't it be both?*

The game is written in **BazzBasic**, a modern BASIC interpreter for Windows with SDL2 graphics and sound. The whole game is a few hundred lines of plain BASIC: no engine, no libraries.



BazzBasic
ekbass.github.io/BazzBasic
github.com/EkBass/BazzBasic

Game by EkBass, 2026. Released under the MIT License.

Credits

Images

All card images were generated or edited with Google Gemini, ChatGPT, or by EkBass.

Music and sounds (all from Pixabay)

File	Author
lofi.mp3 (game music)	ZephiraMusic
pumpkin.mp3 (menu music)	geoffharvey
halloween.mp3 (intro music)	HitsLab
laugh.mp3	freesound_community
correct.mp3	xmer
incorrect.mp3	correct.mp3, reversed